

Chapter 71 Part 11

Su Yao cried day and night, night and day, until she cried one eye blind.

Then every day she would be numb and dazed, thinking about her daughter. Postpartum depression combined with longing turned to illness. Her entire mental state became disordered. She was insane for a long time, until one day when she tried to commit suicide and hit her head on a rock.

She didn't die but lost her memory.

She forgot everyone, only remembering Sheng Qinglin, but only remembering the bits and pieces of their time together.

The memory of Sheng Qinglin's death was too painful, so she forgot it.

The memory of her daughter being snatched away was too painful, so she forgot that too.

Along with it, she forgot Su Zhe, her own brother.

After that came the long road to recovery. Every year her condition would relapse, and she would become crazy and confused.

When Su Zhe thought back to that day, his anger reached the point where he wanted to dig up and whip the corpses of the old Sheng couple.

But he didn't describe the events of that year to Zhou Yi'an in vivid detail. He just explained the whole truth clearly. After finishing, he asked her: "What? Want to help your Teacher Su find her family?"

Zhou Yi'an shook her head: "Teacher Su doesn't even remember. What's the use of finding them?"

"It's not that she doesn't remember." Su Zhe said: "On her daughter's birthday, she becomes especially pained. She cries, she screams, she locks herself in her room and keeps repeating the name Su Qingzhu¹."

"Su Qingzhu?" Zhou Yi'an was surprised.

"That's right." Su Zhe said: "Sheng Qinglin was actually quite good. When Su Yao gave birth to their daughter, he said the daughter was born through Su Yao's hard work, so she should take Su Yao's surname. Then Su Yao put the character 'Qing²' in their daughter's name."

So it should have been Su Qingzhu.

Not Xu Qingzhu.

"Really." Su Zhe said: "If they had even called her Sheng Qingzhu, I could understand. But damn it, they fought so hard to snatch her away, then had her take an outsider's surname. I really want to beat them."

Zhou Yi'an said helplessly: "Then why didn't you snatch her back later?"

"The child was already that old. Wouldn't it be troublesome to have two families fighting over her back and forth?" Su Zhe said: "Besides, Su Yao forgot. It's not good to keep stimulating her. I had people check—Sheng Linlang didn't mistreat the child, so that's fine. Let her grow up peacefully."

Zhou Yi'an had thought Su Zhe would hate the child along with everyone else, but unexpectedly Su Zhe said: "How can I say it—she's still my sister's biological daughter. Although the Sheng family was shameless back then, that child still has to call me uncle. When she kicks Xu Guangyao out, I'll stop suppressing Minghui. Otherwise, I'll keep pressing down on them until they go bankrupt."

Zhou Yi'an: "..."

She suddenly understood why Minghui Technology had taken such a sharp downturn in recent years.

Su Zhe was going for revenge.

After hearing this rather heavy story, Zhou Yi'an asked Su Zhe: "If Teacher Su's daughter wanted to come back and acknowledge her family, would you accept it?"

Su Zhe suddenly froze. After a moment, he smiled bitterly: "If Su Yao accepts, I'll accept. She's Su Yao's daughter."

"But it's still better if she doesn't know." Su Zhe said: "If she knew about these sordid matters, she'd feel terrible. People are happiest when they're ignorant."

Zhou Yi'an nodded and promised him: "I'll keep these matters to myself."

Footnotes:

¹ Su Qingzhu (蘇青竹): This reveals that Xu Qingzhu's original name was supposed to be Su Qingzhu, with her mother's surname "Su" (蘇) rather than "Xu" (許). The "Qing" (青) character connects to her father Sheng Qinglin's name (盛清林), showing the family connection.

² Character 'Qing' (青 vs 清): Interestingly, Xu Qingzhu's current name uses 清 (qīng, meaning "clear/pure") while her original intended name would have used 青 (qīng, meaning "blue/green/young"), which is the same character used in her father Sheng Qinglin's name. Both characters are pronounced "qing" but have different meanings and are written differently.